



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: St. Joseph Catholic Academy
School Website: <https://www.sjc-academy.org/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary - School: Austin Classical School (austinclassical.org) - Overall classification: CLASSICAL - Why: The crawl shows repeated, explicit commitments to a classical, Christian philosophy oriented to truth, goodness, and beauty; a Trivium-structured curriculum (Grammar–Logic–Rhetoric); Great Books and “Great Conversation”; and K–12 pedagogy that includes memorization, recitation, songs, and upper-school debate/discussion. These align tightly with the Six Essential Elements framework and lexicon used in this audit. - Notes: Very strong evidence across Foundations, Purpose, Curriculum, and Pedagogy; public-facing language about faculty formation/portrait is sparse; parent partnership is explicit.

Website used: <https://austinclassical.org/>

Method and Scoring Framework - Source corpus: Newly uploaded crawl for Austin Classical School’s site, including About, Classical Education Basics, and related pages. - Classicality rubric and keyword lexicon: Six Essential Elements positive/negative indicators and the classicality lexicon organized by six categories. These lists drove keyword detection, coverage, and scoring in each category. - Each category below includes: (1) keywords found on the school site; (2) comparison to positive/negative indicators; (3) quantitative estimate of positive vs. negative matches; and (4) category rating.

CATEGORY 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations 1) Keywords/phrases found - From site: “glorify Jesus Christ”; “classical, Christian education”; “wise, virtuous, and humble”; “Truth, Goodness, and Beauty”; “contemplation”. 2) Comparison to indicators - Positive matches: truth, goodness, beauty; virtue, wisdom; Christian/Jesus Christ; contemplation (align with moral realism and theological grounding; positive lexicon terms: truth/goodness/beauty/virtue/wisdom; theology/Christian worldview; contemplation). - Liturgical/communal practices: not clearly evidenced in the crawl excerpt (no explicit chapel/liturgy terms surfaced). - Negative indicators: none observed (e.g., “values-neutral,” “moral relativism”). 3) Quantitative estimate - Positive hits: +9 (truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, virtuous, wisdom, Christian, Jesus Christ, contemplation) - Negative hits: -0 - percent_positive: 100; percent_coverage: 70 (strong on moral realism and theology; limited evidence of liturgy/chapel) 4) Rating: CLASSICAL

CATEGORY 2: School Purpose and Goal 1) Keywords/phrases found - “To cultivate wisdom and virtue ...”; “contemplation of the True, the Good, and the Beautiful”. 2) Comparison to indicators - Positive matches: cultivate/cultivation, wisdom, virtue, truth/goodness/beauty, contemplation — all central to classical ends (formation in wisdom/virtue and pursuit of transcendentals). - Negative indicators: none observed (no “college and career readiness”—first framing, “21st-century skills” marketing, etc.). 3) Quantitative estimate - Positive hits: +8 - Negative hits: -0 - percent_positive: 100; percent_coverage: 90 4) Rating: CLASSICAL

CATEGORY 3: School Curriculum 1) Keywords/phrases found - “The Trivium”; “Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric”; “classical books,” “Great Books,” “Great Conversation”; “integrated curriculum”. 2) Comparison to indicators - Positive matches: Trivium (grammar/logic/rhetoric), Great Books, Great Conversation, integrated/interconnected knowledge — all core positive signals in the lexicon and Six Elements curriculum section. - History vs. “Social Studies”: explicit “history” phrasing not surfaced in the excerpt; no “social studies”—first framing observed. - Negative indicators: none (no dominance of “project-based learning,” “STEM-first” marketing, etc.). 3) Quantitative estimate - Positive hits: +8 (Trivium, Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric, Great Books, Great Conversation, classical books, integrated curriculum) - Negative hits: -0 - percent_positive: 100; percent_coverage: 90 4) Rating: CLASSICAL

CATEGORY 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods 1) Keywords/phrases found - Grammar stage uses “memorization, recitation, and songs”; Logic stage uses “debate and discussion”; method emphasizes

“contemplation” of the True, Good, Beautiful. 2) Comparison to indicators - Positive matches: memorization, recitation, songs/chant analog; debate/discussion in upper grades; contemplation/restfulness (scholè-adjacent language) — strong fit with the pedagogy list in the lexicon and Six Elements (Socratic dialogue, recitation/chanting, restful learning). - “Socratic” and “rhetoric orations/speeches” not explicitly named in the excerpt, but debate/discussion in the Logic/Rhetoric trajectory is strongly suggestive. - Negative indicators: none (no “project-based only,” “student-directed,” etc.). 3) Quantitative estimate - Positive hits: +6 (memorization, recitation, songs, debate, discussion, contemplation) - Negative hits: -0 - percent_positive: 100; percent_coverage: 75 (clear in K–8; upper-school rhetoric speeches/orations not explicitly shown in the excerpt) 4) Rating: CLASSICAL

CATEGORY 5: School Faculty 1) Keywords/phrases found - Employment page exists and lists qualifications; no explicit public language found in the excerpt about “teachers as models of virtue,” “faculty of friends,” or a “portrait of a teacher”. 2) Comparison to indicators - Positive: Not explicitly evidenced in the crawl snippet (we did not surface “mentors,” “living curriculum,” “collegiality,” etc.) per the Six Elements faculty list and lexicon. - Negative: None observed. 3) Quantitative estimate - Positive hits: +0 - Negative hits: -0 - percent_positive: 0; percent_coverage: 20 (faculty page present but little classical language visible in the public text captured) 4) Rating: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

CATEGORY 6: School Parents and Community 1) Keywords/phrases found - Mission emphasizes “co-laboring with families” (partnership). 2) Comparison to indicators - Positive: partnership with parents/co-educators — a core positive cue in the Six Elements and lexicon for community/affections formation. - Additional parent formation (book groups, seminars) and open-campus practices were not surfaced in the excerpt. - Negative indicators: none. 3) Quantitative estimate - Positive hits: +1 (parent partnership) - Negative hits: -0 - percent_positive: 100; percent_coverage: 50 (clear partnership statement; fewer public details on parent formation in the captured text) 4) Rating: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Aggregate Assessment - Element ratings: [1] CLASSICAL; [2] CLASSICAL; [3] CLASSICAL; [4] CLASSICAL; [5] SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL; [6] SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL. - Overall: CLASSICAL. The school’s public materials show robust philosophical grounding, a clearly classical curriculum, and classical pedagogy from K–12. Limited faculty-language evidence and modest parent-formation detail in the visible crawl keep those two categories at SOMEWHAT, but the overall profile is squarely CLASSICAL.

Detailed Keyword Tally Snapshot (selected examples) - Positive: truth, goodness, beauty; wisdom; virtue/virtuous; Christian/Jesus Christ; contemplation; Trivium, Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric; Great Books; Great Conversation; integrated curriculum; memorization; recitation; songs; debate; discussion; co-laboring with families. - Negative: none surfaced (e.g., values-neutral education, social studies-first framing, project-based learning dominance, 21st-century skills marketing) per the lexicon/indicators.

What would move the needle - Not applicable (overall rating is CLASSICAL).

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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